

1.1.5 FreeRIDE

The new programming language, Ruby, is all the rage these days—and it's quite easy to learn, too. Unfortunately, good IDEs for Ruby are hard to come by, but FreeRIDE aims to change all that. It's written in Ruby itself, so is portable across nearly all operating systems, but it also means that it will take longer to start up than native applications. FreeRIDE comes bundled with the Ruby



FreeRIDE is the IDE of choice for Ruby developers

Installer we've given this month on the CD/DVD, so you don't have to worry about installing the Ruby Interpreter separately.

The project is still in development, and isn't very newbie-friendly—you'll need respectable command over Ruby to get to grips with it. Still, it's better than Notepad, and with the online documentation, you can be well on your way to learning Ruby with few hiccups.

You'll find the Project Explorer and Source View panes on the left—the latter is especially useful: it shows you your code properly organised into Modules, Classes and Functions. Overall, FreeRIDE gives you just a little more than the fundamentals—more advanced features will take time—but it's better than the other options you have for Ruby development.

1.1.6 PHP Designer 2007 Personal Edition

The name may say PHP, but PHP Designer is a good bit more. It supports PHP files, HTML, CSS, XML, JavaScript, VBScript, nearly all variations of SQL, Perl, Java, Ruby, Python and C# (whew)—



PHP Designer is more than just PHP